

THE INTERNATIONAL RESPAWN

The International 2025 will be played between September 4-14 and will have **16 teams** competing in two stages — The Road (qualifiers) and The International (main event).

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The Swiss format of competitions has become more and more popular across sports, with football and chess using it, in the UEFA Champions League and the Chess Olympiad 2024, respectively.

Dota 2, which has already implemented it in several of its esports tournaments, has now introduced it in its most important one at a global level — The International (TI).

Dota 2 is a multiplayer online battle arena (MOBA), with over 89 million players (as of January 2025 according to Statista) and remains one of the most popular competitive esports titles in the world.

TI — started in 2011 — has had 10 winners over 13 editions since, with Team Spirit, Team Liquid and OG sports clinching the title thrice each.

TI 2025 will be played in two stages — The Road (qualifiers) and The International (main event) from

September 4 to 14. The Road will take place between September 4 and 7 while TI Proper will take place from September 11-14.

Over the first three days, best-of-three matches will be played between teams with the same series record (a 2:0 team will face another 2:0 team, a 1:3 team will face another 1:3 team, etc.).

Five such rounds — having three games — will be played for a winner. A fourth series win will cause that team to automatically advance to The International; a fourth loss will cause that team to be eliminated.

Three teams with four wins will secure a spot in these rounds while three teams with four losses will be eliminated. The 10 remaining sides will compete in a special elimination round (strongest against weakest) with five winners completing the final roster.

The eight teams will then be seeded according to their performance in The Road, in the form of highest against lowest in a standard double-elimination bracket.

All matches will be best-of-three except the Grand Finals, which will be a best-of-five contest.

TOP 5 VALORANT PLAYERS IN INDIA



VENKATESH
"VENKA" SHARMA



ABHIRUP "LIGHTNINGFAST"
CHOU DHURY



PRANAV
"KOH LII" KOHLI



AKRAM
"RAWFIUL" VIRANI



GANESH
"SKROSSI" GANGADHAR